



Mechanical Keyboards

Clash of the titan(s)

We had plenty of mechanical keyboard launches this year, but there was one undisputed winner who took the crown this year. For the rest, the competition was close; close enough that we've got a runner up and a second runner up. The trend of ditching Cherry MX keys continues, with more brands opting for their own custom switches. It's come to a point where they're as good as Cherry MX switches, and it comes to personal preference and durability.

Winner: Corsair K100 RGB

Presenting the Digit Zero1 winner for the best mechanical keyboard, the Corsair K100 RGB. This is the first keyboard in the world with a polling rate of 4000 Hz. It's able to achieve this because the keyboard has multithreading. Yes, like a CPU. We tested the variant with Corsair's own OPX optical switches which have a linear feel like Red switches. And the actuation distance is 1 mm while the total travel distance is 3.2 mm. The actuation force remains the same at 45 g. There's no denying that they're a joy to type on. When it comes to gaming however, we couldn't tell if it actually gave us a competitive edge. It was definitely very comfortable though. But that's not all, we've got a robust and premium build, including the keycaps and metal scroll wheel, a new programmable



Corsair K100 RGB
Price: ₹18,300



Razer BlackWidow V3 Pro
Price: ₹18,300



Apex 7 TKL
Price: ₹11,999



RedGear Shadow Blade MK853
Price: ₹2,499



control wheel on the top left, 6 programmable macro keys on the left of the keyboard (like the K95), an improved wrist rest, and we haven't even mentioned Corsair's excellent software.

Runner up: Razer BlackWidow V3 Pro

What makes the Razer BlackWidow V3 Pro special is that it boasts all the features of a premium gaming keyboard while also being wireless, offering a 2.4 Ghz connection via a USB dongle, Bluetooth 5.0 and a wired option, for when you're charging the keyboard. The gaming experience on the BlackWidow V3 was also excellent, and there was no noticeable delay or lag when used wirelessly via the HyperSpeed dongle. The battery life on the BlackWidow V3 is also pretty great, but it depends on the RGB, lowering the brightness will give you more time, with 50% brightness offering you around 15 hours. Turning RGB off entirely will give you 20+ hours. The Razer BlackWidow V3 Pro is our Digit Zero1 runner up, and the best wireless keyboard we've tested.

Second Runner Up: Apex 7 TKL

The competition in the mechanical keyboard segment was so tight that we had to have a second runner up as well. The SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL is the best TKL mechanical keyboard you can get your hands on. Thanks to SteelSeries excellent software, it comes with a host of features and an OLED screen built into it that lets you access settings while in-game. The keyboard features a premium build, and the SteelSeries switches feel great to use. The keyboard has Brown, Red and Blue switch options and feels great to type with. They even managed to fit dedicated media controls on the TKL form factor while maintaining decent spacing which ensures a comfortable typing experience.

Best Buy: RedGear Shadow Blade MK853

The amount of value you get out of the RedGear Shadow Blade at just ₹2,500 is quite frankly insane. The Shadow Blade features unbranded blue mechanical switches which makes sense considering the price, per-key RGB with plenty of lighting options, it even comes with a wrist rest, and dedicated media controls including a volume dial on the top right of the keyboard. Even the build is pretty decent making this worth the Best Buy mention.

– Manish Rajesh | manish@digit.in